

Apple iPad 2 coming?

Rumours of a new iPad spread on the internet; expected to launch in Q1 2011

Ubuntu tablets

Rumoured Ubuntu powered tablets seen in China; it's said to be running on an Atom processor

Nvidia finally brings the power of Fermi to Mac

Mac users, especially Mac Pro users, would have been waiting for this – a Fermi-derived workstation GPU. They've finally got the Nvidia Quadro 4000, which will deliver all the DX11 Fermi goodness, with CUDA as the icing on the cake.

CUDA technology, while also relevant for gaming, makes its presence best felt under professional and workstation setups, where GPU-accelerated video encoding and rendering is a must, and ray tracing an often necessary evil. The Quadro 4000 for the Mac also features fast 64-bit double precision floating point capabilities to ensure accurate results in the case of mission critical applications, such as medical imaging and structural analysis. CUDA will also accelerate applications from companies such as Adobe, Autodesk, RTT, Dassault Systemes, Bunkspeed and many more.

The Quadro 4000 prom-

ises 5x faster performance with Fermi than the previous generation, and with its Scalable Geometry Engine, it can process up to 890 million triangles per second. Keeping all this in mind, Nvidia is quick to point out that the Quadro 4000 is more than just a graphics processor, but a visual supercomputing platform which can handle stereoscopic 3D, scalable visualization and 3D high-definition broadcasting.

The card is similar to the Quadro 4000 for PC, and has 256 CUDA cores, 2GB GDDR5 RAM on a 265-bit memory interface, a 475MHz core clock and a 2800 effective memory clock, with a 950MHz shader clock. It will be priced at an identical \$1,199. The biggest difference between the PC version and the Mac version is that the Mac version has 2 DisplayPort outputs, instead of 1 DisplayPort and 1 DVI like the PC version. Also ironic, is that while the Quadro 4000 supports OpenGL 4.1, though Mac OS X is still stuck at OpenGL 2.1. Then again, it would serve OpenCL quite well. 

Live WD TV by month end

Western Digital recently introduced its latest HD media player – the WD TV Live Hub Media Centre in Mumbai. The Live Hub media player will be available in the Indian market by the end of December 2010 and will be priced at ₹9,999.

The Live Hub media centre is a full-HD 1080p media player which houses a 1TB network hard drive within it. It has features like integrated media server, integrated iTunes media server, video feeds via the internet, social networking integration in the form of Facebook and Flickr apps among other features.

Live Hub TV allows you to connect devices such as DSLR, compact cameras, external drives, camcorders via the USB port. "With the WD TV Live Hub media centre, consumers can take their home entertainment experience to the next level, streaming personal content to multiple rooms at the same time," said Khwaja Saifuddin,

senior director sales (Middle East, Africa and South Asia), Western Digital.

Facebook integration was quite unique which allows users to update status, upload photos, view their wall, get the latest newsfeed, in-short do everything that you normally can on a Facebook app. You might need a wireless keyboard if you will use Facebook on the Live Hub as the remote will not do justice. You can also view photos remotely on your iPhones via a WD



Photo app – which is presently only available for the iPhone – provided the Live Hub is powered on.

Daniel Mauerhofer, senior public relations manager, WD said, "We are working on that technology, but our research showed that there wasn't a great demand for such drives. As of now it is not a volumes market." 

Scientists store 9,00,000 GB of data in E. coli bacteria

Scientists have been working on using proteins, bacteria and other organic material as storage media for a while, and if it looks like all those efforts are bearing fruit only now, it doesn't make it any more unlikely! Calling it 'bioencryption by recombination', a team of scientists from Chinese University of Hong Kong (CUHK) have figured out how to store and en/decrypt data onto living bacteria cells.

According to CUHK's mis-

sion statement: CUHK iGEM 2010 team is formed by a group of undergraduates and instructors from the Chinese University of Hong Kong. Our project is to create a brand new biological cryptography system. We harness the incredible adaptability of simple organisms in the tortured environment to make sure that the message stored can be left undisturbed regardless of any environmental changes.

The aim of the project is also to make it extremely resistant

to hacking and environmental damage, which most current solutions are affected by. In essence, the team sought to make bacteria data storage and encryption feasible in the real world, which previously returned very low and impractical data density figures. Now, they've squeezed more than 9,31,322GB of data onto 1 gram of E. Coli bacteria by creating a massively parallel bacterial data storage system. Compared to 1 to 4GB per gram data density of conventional media, 9,00,000GB per

gram is truly astounding.

Taking the dream one step closer to industrial reality, the team has developed data proof-read/correction and random access modules, in addition to an encryption module, all using site-specific recombination of the inversion type. In essence, the team has transferred information onto DNA, and the encoding method to do this used DNA bases, taking adenosine, thymine, cytosine, and guanine to represent numbers 0 to 3. 